



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Mercury is like a giant magnet!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think that the movement of planets can affect how people think or behave? Why or why not?
- Why do you think that some people believe that the planets can affect our minds?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences and strange events.
- I can say what has been happening and what had been happening.
- I can report statements about opinions and beliefs.

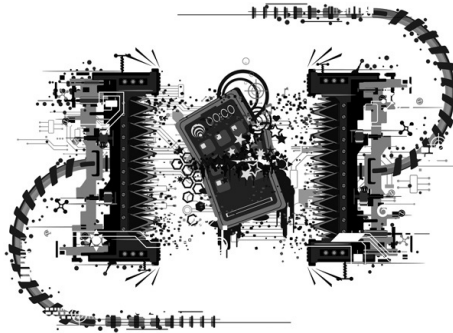




Let's Explore!

Peter talks about his **first-hand experiences*** with Mercury retrograde.

* "First-hand experiences" are things that you actually do or see, not just read or hear about.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** I'm still not really sure about Mercury retrograde. How do you know about it?
- Peter:** I've been reading about it for a while. It started when I had been having a lot of problems at work. My computer crashed and my voicemail wasn't recording any messages. I had just gotten my computer serviced so I didn't understand why it crashed. The guy at the shop reported that he couldn't find anything wrong with it. Then I had been trying for hours to book a flight to go to a conference but all the seats had been sold already. I had been banking on going to this conference and making a lot of new contacts. Also, I had promised my boss that I would go.
- Vanessa:** So what did you do?
- Peter:** I ended up taking a train. I got to the conference but somehow my conference ticket was booked under the wrong name. The hotel had my reservations wrong. They claimed that I had booked for 2018!
- Vanessa:** Sounds like a huge mix-up!
- Peter:** Yeah, and it just seemed like everything I had been trying to schedule fell apart. I was talking on the phone to a friend, telling him everything that had gone wrong. When I hung up, this woman who had been standing near me turned to me and told me that I should read up on Mercury retrograde. She said that it was the cause of all my troubles.
- Vanessa:** How does it cause all these problems?
- Peter:** Mercury has a core of very high-density iron. During the retrograde it's passing closer to the Earth, between the Earth and the Sun. It's like a huge magnet passing by the Earth. People believe that it's the magnetism that causes electronics and computers to go on the fritz. This magnetism also affects our own electrical circuits which explains why people get forgetful, say things they don't mean, or do things they normally wouldn't do.





Let's Practice!

What has been happening with Peter?

Instructions: Select all the correct answers. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Which of the following statements are about events that were unfinished before something else happened or are still continuing?

- 1) ___ I've been reading about it for a while.
- 2) ___ The hotel had my reservations wrong.
- 3) ___ It started when I had been having a lot of problems at work.
- 4) ___ Then I had been trying for hours to book a flight to go to a conference but all the seats had been sold already.
- 5) ___ My conference ticket was booked under the wrong name.
- 6) ___ I had been banking on going to this conference and making a lot of new contacts.
- 7) ___ It just seemed like everything I had been trying to schedule fell apart.
- 8) ___ She said that Mercury was the cause of all my troubles.



Let's Practice!

What a bizarre day!

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

that I would go / that I should read / claimed that I had / reported that he
couldn't / that it was the cause

- 1) He _____ find anything wrong with it.
- 2) I had promised my boss _____.
- 3) They _____ booked for 2018!
- 4) She told me _____ up on Mercury retrograde.
- 5) She said _____ of all my troubles.





Extension Activity

Research a planet.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose one of the nine planets that are in our Sun's orbit.
- Research your planet on the Internet.
- Create a poster to show all the facts that you learned about your planet.
- Present your poster and information to your class or group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research a planet on the Internet.

☐
☐

I create a poster of information about my planet.

☐
☐

I present my information to a group.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **to service** (verb): to repair
e.g. I had just gotten my computer serviced so I didn't understand why it crashed.
- **to end up** (verb): to finally be in a particular place or situation
e.g. I ended up taking a train.
- **to bank on** (verb): to depend upon something or someone
e.g. I had been banking on going to this conference and making a lot of new contacts.
- **magnet** (noun): a piece of iron that is able to attract iron and steel objects toward itself
e.g. It's like a huge magnet passing by the earth.
- **core** (noun): middle
e.g. Mercury has a core of very high-density iron.
- **on the fritz** (expression): broken or not working
e.g. It's the magnetism that causes electronics and computers to go on the fritz.
- **to fall apart** (verb): to break and be unable to continue in the usual way
e.g. It just seemed like everything I had been trying to schedule fell apart.
- **high-density** (adjective): having a high concentration
e.g. You need to use high-density steel in buildings.





Learning Points

Uses of Perfect Continuous Tenses

Perfect Continuous tenses focus on a past period leading up to a present one. They show that an event continues or is/was temporary (like other continuous tenses).

You use the Past or Present Perfect Continuous to talk about something that is incomplete, just finishing or about to change.

For example:

I'd been staring at the screen all night when I suddenly had a great idea.

The Perfect Continuous (both past and present) focuses on the action, rather than the result.

For example:

What have you been doing?

Look at the examples from the text:

Examples:

- *I've been reading about it for a while.*
- *It started when I had been having a lot of problems at work.*
- *Then I had been trying for hours to book a flight to go to a conference but all the seats had been sold already.*
- *I had been banking on going to this conference and making a lot of new contacts.*
- *It just seemed like everything I had been trying to schedule fell apart.*





Learning Points

That-Clauses: Reporting Statements

When you report statements, you can use that-clauses in the reported clause.

For example:

*She **said that** she was enjoying the show.*

You can omit *that* after the most common report verbs, such as: *agree, mention, notice, promise, say* and *think*. However, you do not remove it if the clause does not come right after the verb.

For example:

*He **agreed** with everyone **that** it would be better to wait.*

Examples:

- *The guy at the shop reported that he couldn't find anything wrong with it.*
- *I had promised my boss that I would go.*
- *They claimed that I had booked for 2018!*
- *This woman who had been standing near me turned to me and told me that I should read up on Mercury retrograde.*
- *She said that it was the cause of all my troubles.*

